

# **GOVERNMENT SECONDARY SCHOOL, GWARINPA**

## **ENGLISH**

### **FIRST TERM**

### **SCHEME OF WORK**

1. SPEECH: consonant sounds /j/, /z/, /ʒ/. Vocabulary: words associated with home and family. Structure: nouns – types of nouns. Comprehension: reading to comprehend main story line. Writing: narrative composition.
2. SPEECH: consonant sounds /dʒ/, /θ/. Vocabulary: words associated with agriculture. Comprehension: reading to comprehend main story line II. Structure: Nouns – revision. Writing: expository composition.
3. SPEECH: consonants followed by /w/. Structure: noun phrases. Comprehension: reading to comprehend supporting details. Writing: mechanics in writing i.e. paragraphing, punctuation and spelling.
4. SPEECH: consonants followed by /j/. Comprehension: reading to comprehend supporting details II. Writing: mechanics in writing II.
5. SUMMARY: introduction to summary through identifying key words. Structure: countable and non-countable nouns. Writing: writing of articles.
6. SPEECH: syllabic consonants /l/. Structure: introducing nominalisation of adjectives and verbs. Summary: introduction to summary (continued).
7. SPEECH: syllabic consonant /n/. Structure: pronoun. Writing: letter writing (informal). Vocabulary: words associated with animal husbandry.
8. SPEECH: words of two syllables. Structure: possessive pronoun. Comprehension: reading to comprehend word meaning through context. Summary: reading to assign a title to context.
9. SPEECH: words of two syllables II. Vocabulary: words associated with religion – Traditional. Structure: regular and irregular verbs. Comprehension: reading to make notes.
10. SPEECH: listening to tell the meaning of words I context. Structure: complex tense forms. Writing: descriptive composition. Comprehension: reading to identify writer's mood, tone and purpose.
11. SPEECH: consonant sounds followed by /k+/w/. Structure: demonstrative pronouns. Vocabulary: words associated with religion – Islaam and Christianity. Writing: formal letter.

12. SPEECH: listening to identify a speaker's style. Writing: semi-formal letter. Structure: differences between phrase and clause. Summary: writing a summary of a passage in a specified number of sentences.
13. Revision.
14. Examination.

### **SPEECH: Consonant Sounds /j/, /z/, /3/**

There are 44 speech sounds in the English language whereby, 20 of the sounds are termed 'vowels', whilst the other 24 sounds are considered 'consonants'. Vowels and consonants differ depend on their parameters of production. Vowels are produced with free-flow of air, i.e. without any obstruction of airflow, while consonants are produced with a complete or partial obstruction of air at one place or the other from the vocal tract.

The following are some selected few consonant sounds:

**/j/** as in **y**ou, **y**am, **y**es, **y**acht, **y**oung

**/z/** as in **z**ip, **z**ebra, **z**ero, **z**increase, **z**arise, **z**those, **z**buses, **z**churches, **z**bags

**/3/** as in **p**leasure, **m**easure, **t**reasure, **v**ision, **c**onfusion, **d**ivision, **t**elevision

### **Vocabulary: Words Associated with Home and Family**

Family related words:

- Ancestor: predecessor in family
- Care-giver: a person who cares for someone who is sick or disabled
- Heir: a person who inherits or has a right of inheritance in the property of another following the latter's death
- Hereditary: descending or capable of descending to succeeding generations by inheritance, derived from one's ancestors
- Infant: a child during the earliest period of its life, especially before he or she can walk; baby
- Juvenile: young, youthful or immature
- Kin: a person of the same family; related
- Kinship: family relationship

- Kith: blood relatives
- Lineage: direct descent from a particular ancestor
- Matriarch: a woman who rules a family, clan or tribe
- Offspring: children or young of a particular parent or progenitor
- Paternal: relating to or characteristic of a father or fatherhood; fatherly
- Patriarch: a man who rules a family, clan or tribe
- Progeny: the immediate descendants of a person
- Sibling: a person's brother or sister

### **Structure: Nouns – Types of Nouns**

Noun: is a word that identifies a person, place or thing. In short; noun is a naming word, anything that has name it is a noun.

Another way of recognising a noun is by its: ending, position and function.

#### **Noun Ending**

There are certain word endings that show that a word is a noun, for example:

- -ity = nationality
- -ment = appointment
- -ness = happiness
- -tion = relation
- -hood = childhood

#### **Noun Position in Sentence**

A noun can be often recognised by its position in the sentence. Nouns often come after a determiner (a, an, the, this, my, such, etc). for example:

- A relief
- An afternoon
- The doctor
- This word
- My house
- Such stupidity

## Noun Function in Sentence

Nouns have certain functions (jobs) in a sentence, for example:

- Subject of verb; Doctors work hard.
- Object of verb; he likes coffee.
- Subject and object of verb; teachers teach students.

## Types of Nouns

### Proper Nouns

Names of people, places or organisations are proper nouns. Your name is a proper noun. Egypt is a proper noun. United Nations is a proper noun.

Rule: proper nouns always start with a capital letter. Examples: Auwal, Nigeria, Friday, Shakespeare.

- Isa introduced himself.
- He is the chairman of Algeria Broadcasting Corporation.
- The capital of Saudi is Ryadh.
- He was born in November.

### Concrete Nouns

All things that are physical and one can touch or otherwise sense is termed as concrete nouns. Examples: rice, car, furniture, mobile phone, etc.

- Many books do you have?
- Pour the water.
- Give me the computer.

### Abstract Nouns

These are the opposite of concrete nouns. They are things that one cannot touch. Abstract nouns are idea, concepts and feelings. Examples: happiness, courage, danger, truth, etc.

- He has great strength.
- Who killed Kennedy is a real mystery.
- Sometimes it takes courage to tell the truth.
- Their lives were full of sadness.

## Collective Nouns

A collective noun denotes a group of individuals. Examples: class (group of students), pride (group of lions), crew (group of sailors), etc.

Rule: collective nouns can be treated as singular or plural.

- His family live in different countries.
- The new company is the result of a merger.
- The board of directors will meet tomorrow.

## Common Nouns

Most nouns are common nouns. Common nouns refer to people and things in general like chair or cat. Any noun that is not a name is a common noun. Examples: teacher, car, receipt, etc.

- Have you seen his cat?
- The books are on your desk.
- The phone is ringing.

## Noun Countability

The major division of English nouns is into 'Countable' and 'Non-countable' nouns.

Countable nouns are easy to recognise. They are things that we can count. For example: 'pen' we can count pens. We can have one, two, three or more pens. Here are some more countable nouns:

Dog, cat, animal, bottle, box, coin, note, cup, plate, spoon, table, chair, bag, etc.

Countable nouns can be singular or plural:

- His cat is playing.
- His cats are playing.

We can use the indefinite article ('a' or 'an') with countable nouns:

- A cat is an animal.

## Non-Countable Nouns

Unlike countable nouns, non-countable nouns are substances, concepts, etc that we cannot divide into separate elements. We cannot 'count' them generally. For example: milk. We can count bottles of milk, or litres of milk, but we cannot count milk itself. Here are some more non-countable nouns:

Art, happiness, information, furniture, electricity, work, power, advice, news, luggage, rice, sugar, gas, water, butter, currency, etc. we usually treat non-countable nouns as singular, and use singular verb. For example:

- This news is very important.
- Your luggage looks heavy.

### **Comprehension: reading to comprehend main story line**

Comprehension is involves constructing mental representations of the information presented. Connecting it to existing knowledge, and making inferences to fill in gaps. Comprehension goes beyond mere decoding of words; it encompasses the understanding of idea, concepts and relationships conveyed through language.

Some reading practical exercises are found in the following categories:

- Reading for kids
- Short stories
- Reading about interests; sport, art, history, legends, etc
- Reading about movies; horror, sci-fi, drama, action, documentaries, etc
- Reading about recent historical events
- Reading about environmental issues
- Reading about health issues
- Reading classical texts; religious books, ancient books; like Shakespearean works

### **Writing: Narrative Composition**

A narrative essay could be fiction (unreal, imaginative) or non-fiction (true life). A good narrative essay involves correct spellings and real life conditions. Meanwhile, in exam conditions a guided topic or theme is given for the student to write a story. Also, the number of words is not less than 450 prescribed. This makes a narrative essay in this context a flash fiction or a short story.

## Features of Narrative Essay

Note that a good narrative essay must have:

- a. Title and paragraphs as well as conversations which are indented and put in speech marks (‘ ’ or “ ”).
- b. Characters
- c. Settings.
- d. Plot. Since it involves story-telling, the storyline or plot can either be:
  - 1) Chronological: Here, the story goes from beginning to middle which captures the conflict and climax and then to the end which includes the resolution or denouement and anti-climax.
  - 2) Non-Chronological: another word for this is episodic. Here, the story is structured anticlockwise.

It is pertinent to note that what makes a narrative essay very interesting and attract good marks is its literary embellishments with figures of speech such as metaphor, simile, irony, hyperbole, personification, euphemism etc.

Also, note that in an instance where a topic is not given, you are expected to coin a topic from the subject matter you are to write about which can either be a word which in most cases can be a name of a character in the story, or a phrase. However, when a topic is given then adopt it as your topic.

### **SPEECH: consonant sounds /ð/, /θ/**

**/ð/** this, **them**, **those**, **father**, **mother**, **brother**, **breathe**

**/θ/** **think**, **thank**, **thin**, **anthem**, **author**, **Mathematics**, **mouth**, **both**, **breath**